for a greater "ability of popular representatives at all levels to *make well-thought-out decisions* (and evaluate their results) regarding all of the issues which affect the citizenry."[48] Likewise, Haroldo Dilla argues that Cuba needs "a more pluralist approach to politics, in accordance with the sociological, cultural, ideological, etc. diversity of the country" – but with the recognition that "pluralism cannot be reduced to the organization of several political parties. In fact, 'actually existing' multi-party systems have shown a tenacious incapacity to reflect the diversity that exists in society, diversity which in large part has tended to be expressed outside of the formal party system."[49]

Hugo Azcuy explained the difference in the Cuban view of "pluralism" from that in the United States this way: "In Cuban political culture today, identity includes social values that go beyond national traits. It would be incomprehensible to conceive of Cuban society as a mosaic of separate compartments, of unconnected sectors that have nothing in common except the fact that they coexist side by side. Cuban identity comes from a strong sense of community, forged in almost four decades of sacrifice and dangers, particularly because of having to confront external enemies that are hostile to the revolution … In this context, pluralism does not mean moving towards fragmentation and rupture of Cuban society."[50]

Note that Azcuy does not reject the notion of pluralism in Cuban society. In fact, he argues that political developments in Cuba during the 1980s and into the 1990s went precisely in the direction of recognizing and accommodating pluralism.

> The need for a more pluralistic expression of Cuban society has been accentuated in the recent years of the crisis, but its antecedents are in the second half of the 1980s, when people began to publicly question the copying of the Soviet institutional and ideological model that began in the 1970s. In 1990 there was an important public debate, which even had a mass character, about the need to introduce changes at the root of the institutional system. Among the most important steps in this process were the new space given to private, non-profit associations, and also to religious organizations.